

Galaxy gazing

You'll need to look carefully to find a galaxy because it will be very small in the sky. You can see the galaxies shown below, but get your eyes used to the dark first. The star maps on pp.20–23 will show you where to find them.



The Andromeda Galaxy is the most distant object you can see without a telescope.

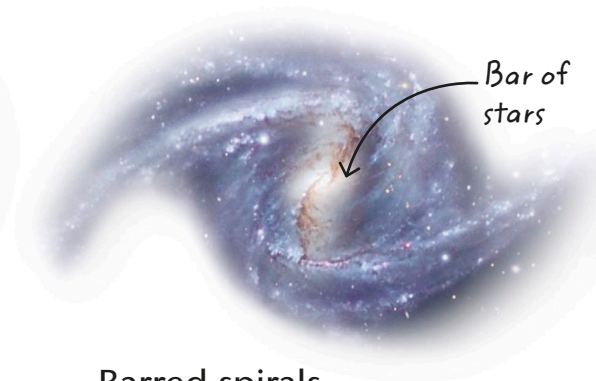


This is the Small Magellanic Cloud in the southern sky.



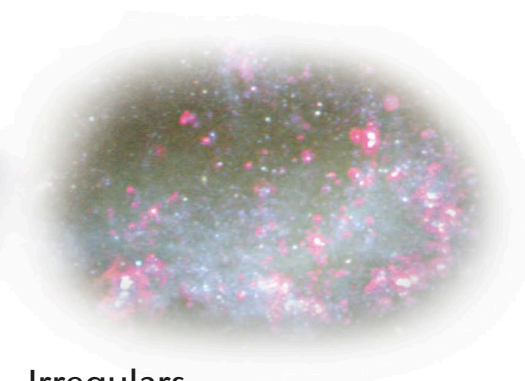
Magellan

Early astronomers in Europe and Asia could see only the northern sky. Ferdinand Magellan, a Portuguese explorer, sailed south 500 years ago and saw two galaxies. They are now called the Small and Large Magellanic Clouds.



Barred spirals

In this type of spiral galaxy, the stars form a bar in the center. The arms of stars curl out from both ends of the bar.



Irregulars

Some galaxies have no particular shape at all. These are called irregular galaxies. They are the rarest type of galaxy.